Pre-Discussion Research Submission Sheets (Task 2)

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 2 • Mandatory Advance Submission
Discussion Topic: Digital Monitoring vs Face-to-Face Consultations in Healthcare

■ Candidate A: Constantin (Healthcare Support Worker)

Verified Source: Royal College of Nursing (RCN) & Trust Operational Audit

- Focus: Clinical limitations of automated sensors vs physical examination.
- Evidence: RCN audit revealed 41% of early stage pressure ulcers missed on virtual reviews.
- Case Example: Patient with normal sensor readings had severe bed-bound deterioration.
- Conclusion: Sensors are an adjunct; face-to-face visits remain non-negotiable for frail adults.

■ Candidate B: Thomas (Therapy Assistant)

Verified Source: The King's Fund (2024): 'Digital Health in Practice'

- Focus: System efficiency, hospital avoidance & chronic disease monitoring.
- Evidence: Telemetry reduced hospital readmissions by 22% for heart failure patients.
- Evidence: Clinic 'Did Not Attend' (DNA) rates plummeted from 12% to under 4%.
- Conclusion: Continuous daily physiological trends offer earlier warning than sporadic clinic visits.

■ Candidate C: Amara (Care Co-ordinator)

Verified Source: Healthwatch England & Age UK Reports on Digital Exclusion

- Focus: The digital divide, sensory barriers & non-verbal safeguarding risks.
- Evidence: 34% of service users aged 75+ lack digital literacy or smartphone access.
- Evidence: Subtle safeguarding red flags (domestic abuse, self-neglect) cannot be seen on phones.
- Conclusion: A blended model supported by 'Digital Health Champions' is required for health equity.